

Davide Gaspar

Principal Software Engineer and CI/CD Developer Experience Team Lead (Vice-President) at **JPMorgan Chase**

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As a Principal Software Engineer and Team Lead at JPMorgan Chase, I led the CI/CD Developer Experience team through a large-scale migration of over 500 microservices and 600+ engineers from legacy platforms to Harness and GitHub Actions, significantly improving deployment security and compliance while minimizing disruption. At Condé Nast, I architected and delivered a global multi-tenant cloud platform serving 20+ brands and supporting over 200 engineers, enabling millions of daily user requests across 11 markets. With more than 13 years of experience, my expertise includes DevOps practices, Infrastructure as Code (Terraform), container orchestration (Docker, Kubernetes), and cloud platforms (AWS, ECS, EKS), along with advanced proficiency in JavaScript, Python, Golang, and Node.js. I consistently apply agile methodologies and lead teams in implementing robust, scalable systems that improve developer productivity and reliability at scale.

Guiding principles

Communication

I foster collaboration through the use of common language, actively challenge assumptions, maintain high situational awareness, and practice open communication.

Development

I've refined a development approach that prioritizes user needs, eliminates bias and redundancy, employs contextually appropriate methods and tools including agile practices, focuses on value-based outcomes rather than contractual obligations, applies standards when appropriate, and delivers solutions characterized by speed, cost-effectiveness, restraint, and elegance (FIRE).

Leadership

I excel by executing quickly rather than waiting for perfection, embracing strategy as an iterative process, taking full ownership, thinking ambitiously to inspire others, navigating complexity with confidence, remaining committed to direction while adapting the path, leading with humility, exploiting the surrounding landscape, and recognizing the transient nature of all systems.

Learning

I cultivate growth through systematic data-informed learning, practical application, curiosity-driven risk-taking, and attentive ecosystem monitoring for future opportunities.

Operations

I drive operational excellence by focusing on granular details, implementing robust failure management strategies, challenging organizational inertia, prioritizing effectiveness over efficiency, optimizing workflow by eliminating bottlenecks, fostering continual improvement with fewer resources, and establishing exceptional standards that exceed industry expectations.

Structure

I advocate for small, empowered teams with distributed decision-making, focusing on aptitude and attitude while providing purpose, mastery, and autonomy to diverse team cultures (pioneers, settlers, town planners) designed for constant evolution.

Technology and Practices Experience

Strategy and Planning

Wardley Maps, Agile software development methodologies, Small iterations via Kanban and Scrum, and ceremonies like Stand-up, Planning, Backlog refinement and Retrospectives.

Architecture

Domain Driven Design (DDD), CQRS, Serverless, Step Functions, Event driven Publish/Subscribe (Pub/Sub), Load balancing, Cloud Network, VPN, Pritunl Zero (Beyond Corp Proxy), Monolith and Microservices.

Development

SOLID Principles, AI Code IDE, Pair Programming, Code review, Mentoring and Refactoring, Bitbucket and Github Version Control, Python and NodeJS and Serverless, NodeJS and Typescript for CLI tools and quick prototyping, Golang for Terraform Providers and Kubernetes, NodeJS, REST API with GraphQL and React UI, CRUD, Authentication / Authorisation, Okta SSO Integration, Rate Limiting, DNS, Web Application Firewall(WAF), Content Delivery Network (CDN).

Automation

DevOps practices, Terraform for Infrastructure as Code (IaC), Jenkins and CircleCI for Continuous Integration, Artifactory for artifact storage, NodeJS NPM, Java Maven, Python PIP, Docker images and Helm.

Deployment

AWS Code Pipeline Spinnaker, Harness for Continuous Delivery (CD) Pipelines. Strategies: Rollout, Blue-Green, Canary and Feature flag deployment strategies.

Operations

Playbooks, Runbooks, Incident management and Post-mortems.

Testing

Test Driven Development (TDD) for robust unit tests, End to End Testing, Smoke testing.

Security

Security Integration (DevSecOps), Static code scanning with Sonar Qube, and Container Scanning with AWS Elastic Container Registry, Open Policy Agent (OPA) to check for control policy compliance, Cloud governance and Auditing.

Reliability

Disaster-Recovery plans and architectures, MySQL and Aurora SQL Databases for Consistency, DynamoDB for low latency, Elastic Kubernetes Service (EKS) for Container compute orchestration, and scalability.

Observability

Kibana Dashboard and Elasticsearch/OpenSearch for logs, Grafana Dashboard and Prometheus and Thanos for scalable Metrics Events and Traces, Datadog, Splunk and AWS CloudWatch full featured observability including anomaly detection.

Notable Initiatives

Leadership and Management Training at JPMorgan Chase

Completed a total of 10 days of in person Leadership and Management courses covering:

- Building a Team: *Professional and Management capabilities, Conflict management*
- Empowering a Team: *Delegation, Change, Stress, Energy, Resilience*
- Diversity Equity and Inclusion: *Trust, Behaviours and Micro Aggressions*
- Guiding Careers: *Hiring, Career conversations*
- Driving Performance: *Goal setting, Competence and Commitment, Leadership Styles*
- Coaching: *GROW model, Trust, Listening, Questioning*
- Feedback: *CAR/AR model*

Lead a team of 8 engineers, with 5 being direct reports.

Global Platform Project at Condé Nast

Responsible for technical leadership of a comprehensive platform modernization project serving iconic media brands including Vogue, GQ, Wired, and The New Yorker, processing millions of daily requests across more than 20 tenants. I designed robust multi-tenant architecture utilizing Terraform for infrastructure as code, Helm for Kubernetes application deployment, Docker for containerization, and integrated observability solutions for monitoring and troubleshooting. Key achievements include developing a CLI tool that modernizes legacy applications and deploys to production within an hour, creating practical engineering Labs promoting best practices, establishing GitHub Actions workflows for CI/CD automation, designing migration pathways for teams transitioning from legacy systems, and regularly presenting platform innovations to drive adoption and collect valuable feedback.

Services, UI and DNS migration to AWS at eFinancialCareers

Successful zero-downtime migration all our stacks to AWS, by building a template micro service stack that ran Docker applications on EC2 using Terraform. All micro services now follow a standard Infrastructure Stack including Route53, WAF, ELBs/ALBs, CloudFront, Nginx, Docker, ASG/EC2, CloudWatch Metrics Alarms and Dashboards and Splunk logging. All micro services have a Pipeline (CodePipeline) complete with Github and Jenkins integration, that build, deploy and test each service. All micro services have a Runbook for On Call support.

Wardley Maps - *Topographical intelligence in business.*

- Practitioner of [Wardley Maps](#)
- Attendee at multiple [Map Camp](#) events.

Cynefin Framework - *Framework for Decision Making and Action.*

Completed [Cynefin](#) online courses:

- Cynefin 101 - Getting started
- Cynefin 102 - Models & Decision Making
- Cynefin 110 - Domain models (3x3s)

Domain Driven Design - *Approach to software development*

Practitioner and Attendee at multiple Domain-Driven Design conferences.

Completed the following courses:

- 3 day Course, [Event Storming](#) Master Class with Alberto Brandolini.
- 5 day Course, Domain Models in Practice: DDD, CQRS & Event Sourcing with Marco Heimeshoff.

Work Experience

JPMorgan Chase - *Full-time • 2yrs 6mos • London, United Kingdom*

Roles

- CI/CD Team Lead at DevEx Group (Vice-President) • *Apr 2023 - Feb 2025 • 1yr 11mos*
- Principal Software Engineer at DevEx Group (Vice-President) • *Sep 2022 - Mar 2023 • 7mos*

Technology and Practices

Responsibilities

Strategy

Led cross-functional Wardley mapping workshops to identify value chains and capability maturity, partner with product teams and leadership to translate business objectives into prioritized technical initiatives, allocate engineering resources strategically, and articulate our technology roadmap to external stakeholders.

Planning

Interfaced with Product Managers to develop Epics and Stories, set up Jira roadmaps, drive quarterly Program Increment Planning, coordinate cross-team activities with stakeholders, facilitate retrospectives and strategy prioritization, assign engineers to epics, collaborate daily with Architecture, Security, and Governance teams, make complex technical trade-offs to achieve consensus, articulate end-to-end domain decisions, and keep stakeholders informed.

Operations

Architected and implemented end-to-end incident management operations, encompassing post-mortem processes, structured issue intake pipelines, detailed Playbooks and Runbooks, proactive observability alerts, and systematic issue tracking and closure methodologies that significantly enhanced system reliability for our services.

Team Management

Successfully merged and led a cross-timezone CI/CD team of 8 engineers, overseeing daily operations, vendor management, and governance while establishing engineering best practices, conducting knowledge sharing sessions, and maintaining clear communication channels with leadership through regular town hall and demos.

People management

Managed 5 direct reports across 2 time zones, responsible for full employee lifecycle management (hiring, onboarding, offboarding), conducting regular 1:1s, overseeing attendance and leave, driving recruitment processes, handling HR matters, providing performance reviews, and fostering team development through coaching, feedback, DEI and leadership training.

Developer Experience (DevEx)

Pioneered the development and execution of a three-pillar Developer Experience strategy encompassing documentation, a feature-rich CLI tool for automation, and community engagement initiatives, while architecting a tenanted CI/CD system, delivering proofs of concept, and establishing effective collaboration with controls teams for compliance and governance.

Continuous Delivery (CD)

Led the enterprise-wide migration from legacy Spinnaker to Harness for Continuous Delivery, designing a secure distributed worker architecture on AWS ECS Fargate Clusters that integrated seamlessly with existing infrastructure (proxy, Jfrog, Jenkins, AWS EKS, Terraform), implementing compliance controls and distributed caching to improve security posture, managing the vendor, and successfully balancing technical excellence with delivery timelines for 600+ engineers and 500+ microservices.

Continuous Integration (CI)

Spearheaded comprehensive DevOps operations and strategic improvements across the technology stack, including CI pipelines (Jenkins Cloudbees), source code management (Bitbucket), artifact storage (Jfrog Artifactory), code quality (SonarQube), and Infrastructure as Code (Terraform Enterprise), while architecting a complex migration to GitHub and GitHub Actions with meticulous planning, risk control, and identity provider integration.

Condé Nast - Full-time • 3yrs 9mos • London, United Kingdom

Roles

- Principal Engineer at Cloud Platform Team • Jan 2022 - Aug 2022 • 8mos
- Senior Software Engineer at Cloud Platform Team • Dec 2018 - Dec 2021 • 3yrs 1mo

Responsibilities

Team

Cross-timezone, diverse remote Agile/SCRUM/Kanban team, I support 200+ engineers across 11 markets by maintaining multi-region AWS environments, global Kubernetes clusters, and custom Golang/NodeJS tooling while participating in incident management and on-call rotations.

We lead, educate, advocate the principles and practices of DevOps across all of Condé Nast, Build tools, provide services and help teams to efficiently own the life-cycle of their applications, Consulting with teams through pairing to facilitate optimal use of the platform.

Planning

Drove planning sessions following the Story mapping framework and DDD principles. Projects included building Global Kubernetes Clusters and Running our entire tech stack in China.

Consulting

Education and Onboarding of Engineers into our Cloud Platform, ran Clinics and Pairing/Troubleshooting sessions with Engineers. Surveyed the Engineering Organization on DevOps Maturity to understand the main gaps across Condé Nast Engineering in order to address them. Responsible for demos, announcements and general platform updates to the wider Engineering Organization.

Recruitment

Interviewed dozens of candidates over the entire recruitment lifecycle, across multiple levels (Junior/Intermediate/Senior Software Engineers), both permanent and contract, for teams across the organization. The interviews cover the candidate's situation and motivation, experience and technical ability as well as their attitude and approach to work.

DNS and Edge Services

Owner of CDN (Fastly), responsible for TLS Certificates management, IaC Best practices (Terraform), and Engineer access. Owner of DNS root zones domain registration, responsible for zone delegation and IaC Best practices (Terraform).

AWS account Provisioning and Cloud Governance

Responsible for Orchestrated (CircleCI Pipelines) AWS account Provisioning via Terraform (Infrastructure as Code), owner of Best Practices and distribution of Terraform Modules for all Engineering. Designed and built the Audit log system. Owner of resource Tagging best practices as well as cost saving and security integrations.

Access Management

Management of Engineer access via Okta SSO Integration, Github, VPN, Pritunl Zero (Beyond Corp Proxy) and secure secret storage via 1Password and Keybase. Owners of the Joiners/Movers/Leavers process for several of the services we provide.

AWS Network

Project Lead in the Networking layer for our Global Platform (AWS EKS based), responsible for defining requirements, testing and coordinating teams in order to deliver a networking solution that supports both the build out of new AWS EKS Clusters as well as the migration of our main properties (Vogue, GQ, Wired, etc.) in a staggered manner, allowing teams to move applications at their own pace.

Continuous Integration / Continuous Delivery (CI/CD)

Owner of helm charts used by Engineers to deploy to Kubernetes as well as best practices like rollback strategies. Owner of custom docker images and docker image repository (Quay.io) distribution, security scan, access and availability. Owner of CircleCI Enterprise and SaaS, responsible for SLOs, upgrades and secret management.

CircleCI

Serves 150+ engineers around the world. Designed and built the supporting infrastructure with IaC, including DNS, Load balancing, Scaling, Zero Trust Authentication and Backup systems. Responsible for maintenance and monitoring (SLOs), configuration, upgrades and engineer experience.

DHI Group, Inc. - Full-time • 3yrs 3mos • London, United Kingdom

Role

- Senior Software Engineer at Cloud Platform Engineering Team • Jan 2018 - Dec 2018 • 1yr

Responsibilities

I joined a cross-timezone US team to deliver comprehensive tooling solutions and organizational guidance, including the development of an internal CloudFormation CLI tool in Python that enabled rapid deployment of nested test stacks while enforcing naming and tagging policies. I spearheaded multiple infrastructure initiatives by creating CloudFormation templates for secret management via Parameter Store and Lambda, AWS Lambda log shipping to Splunk, metrics integration with InfluxDB, encrypted artifact storage using S3 and KMS, and CodeBuild integrations with both CodePipeline and GitHub. Additionally, I produced architecture diagrams, detailed documentation, and best practices guidelines while conducting ECS Fargate proof-of-concepts to evaluate container versus Lambda solutions across the organization.

Role

- Senior Software Engineer at eFinancialCareers Team • Jan 2017 - Dec 2017 • 1yr
- Javascript Developer at eFinancialCareers Team • Oct 2015 - Dec 2016 • 1yr 3mos

Responsibilities

I successfully led critical infrastructure modernization initiatives, migrating our entire technology ecosystem to AWS while implementing sophisticated deployment automation that resulted in 50+ CI/CD pipelines, 15 of which operate with zero human intervention from source control to production. I delivered comprehensive solutions spanning infrastructure design, tooling development, and component creation using the latest technologies including Terraform, AWS Lambda, and React JS, while establishing testing frameworks encompassing unit, black box, end-to-end, and smoke testing methodologies. My collaborative approach involved daily partnership with diverse internal stakeholders, active participation in technical recruitment processes, strategic mentoring of emerging engineers, and the development of enhanced onboarding frameworks that significantly improved team productivity and operational capabilities. I was responsible for the ongoing development and enhancement of our AngularJS-based WebStore platform, delivering advanced analytics integration, A/B testing capabilities, and key business features while maintaining comprehensive quality assurance through Protractor end-to-end testing suites. I significantly improved our development ecosystem by implementing Gulp and NPM optimization tools, led strategic improvements to our team's git workflow through simplified branching strategies and enhanced pull request processes

Lead Galaxy - Full-time • 1yr 1 mo • London, United Kingdom

Role

- Full Stack Web Developer • Oct 2014 - Oct 2015 • 1yr 3mos

Responsibilities

Developed comprehensive full-stack applications utilizing PHP, Node.js, ASP.NET, AngularJS, and SQL databases, while implementing analytics tracking, API integrations, and automation tools that enhanced website performance, conversion rates, and operational efficiency for clients

Vitamin London - *Full-time • 11 mos • London, United Kingdom*

Role

- Front & Middle-End Web Developer • *Nov 2013 - Sep 2014 • 11 mos*

Responsibilities

Led JavaScript development initiatives across diverse project scales, from e-commerce platform integrations to custom web applications with full API implementations, creating impactful client solutions and internal development tools including photo cropping utilities and UI kits while maintaining rigorous testing standards for cross-platform compatibility.

Self-Employed - *Part-time • 3yrs • Lisbon, Portugal*

Role

- Freelance Web Developer • *2011 - 2013 • 3yrs*

Responsibilities

Worked on various improvements and new features in existing websites in the hospitality industry using HTML, CSS, Javascript, PHP and MySQL.

Education

University of Lisbon (UL) - Faculty of Fine Arts Lisbon (FBAUL)

2012 - 2013 • Lisbon, Portugal

MA in Equipment Design (6 Units). Units completed successfully and with an overall average of 15 points (out of 20).

Laureate International Universities - Universidade Europeia

2009 - 2012 • Lisbon, Portugal

BA Hons in Information Systems, Web and Multimedia. Degree Completed with an overall average of 15 points (out of 20).

Languages

English (Advanced), Portuguese (Native) and Japanese (Beginner)